

The Scale of the Problem

21M

Total Patients on Waiting Lists

2M

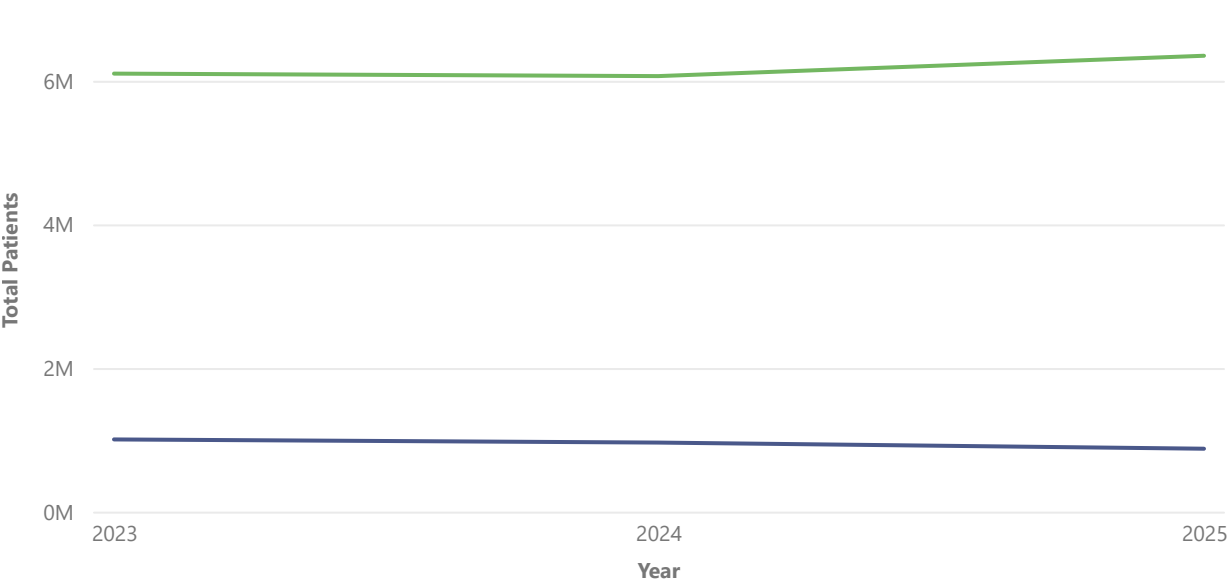
Waiting 18+ Months

17.36

Avg % Waiting Over 12 Months (%)

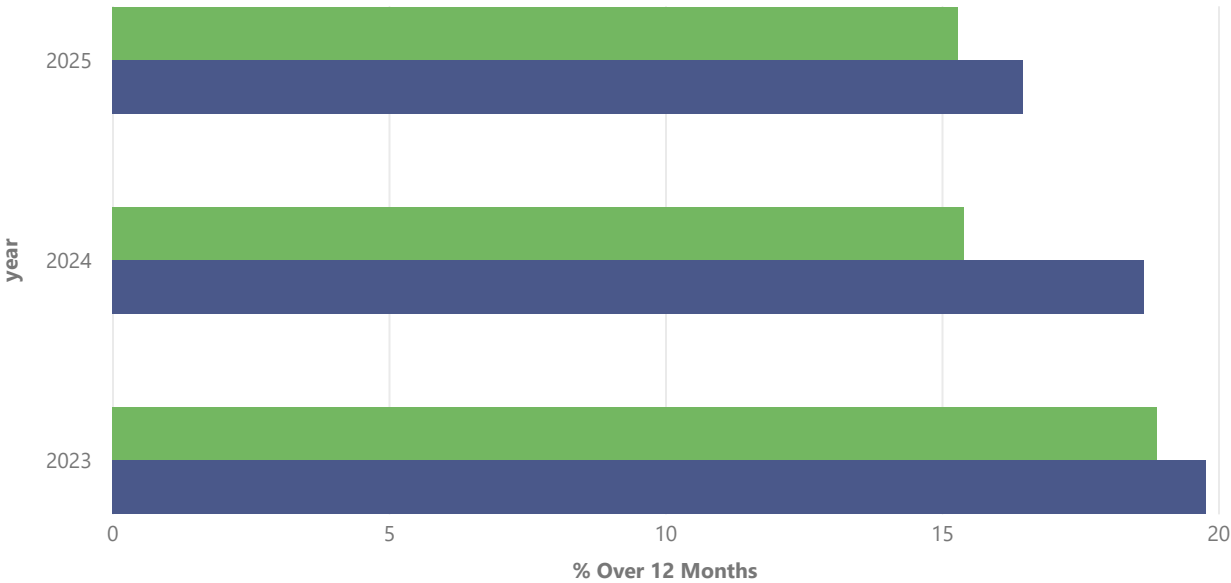
Total Patients on Waiting Lists 2023–2025

adult_child ● Adult ● Child



Average % Waiting Over 12 Months by Year

adult_child ● Adult ● Child



Key Insights

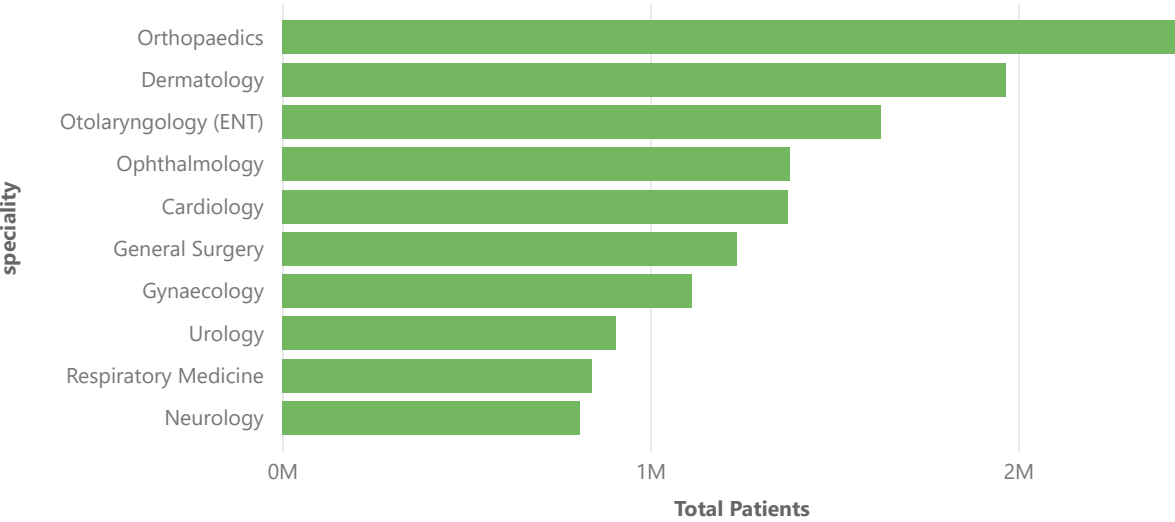
- Between 2023 and 2025, over 21 million patient waiting records were recorded across Irish public hospitals. The number of adults on waiting lists grew each year, while the number of children waiting slowly decreased.
- Progress is being made on long waits. The share of patients waiting more than 12 months dropped from 19% in 2023 to 16% in 2025, showing that efforts to clear the backlog are working.
- Despite this progress, children are being left behind. In 2024 and 2025, a higher proportion of children than adults were waiting over 12 months for care. This gap in children's services needs to be addressed as a priority.

Where The Pressure Is

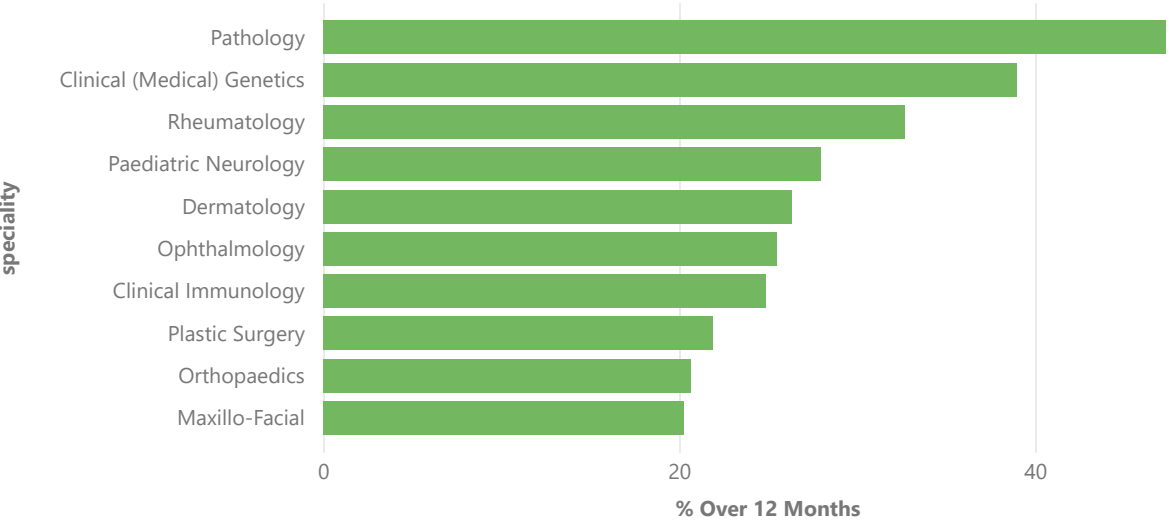
Year Slicer

All

Top 10 Specialties by Total Patients Waiting

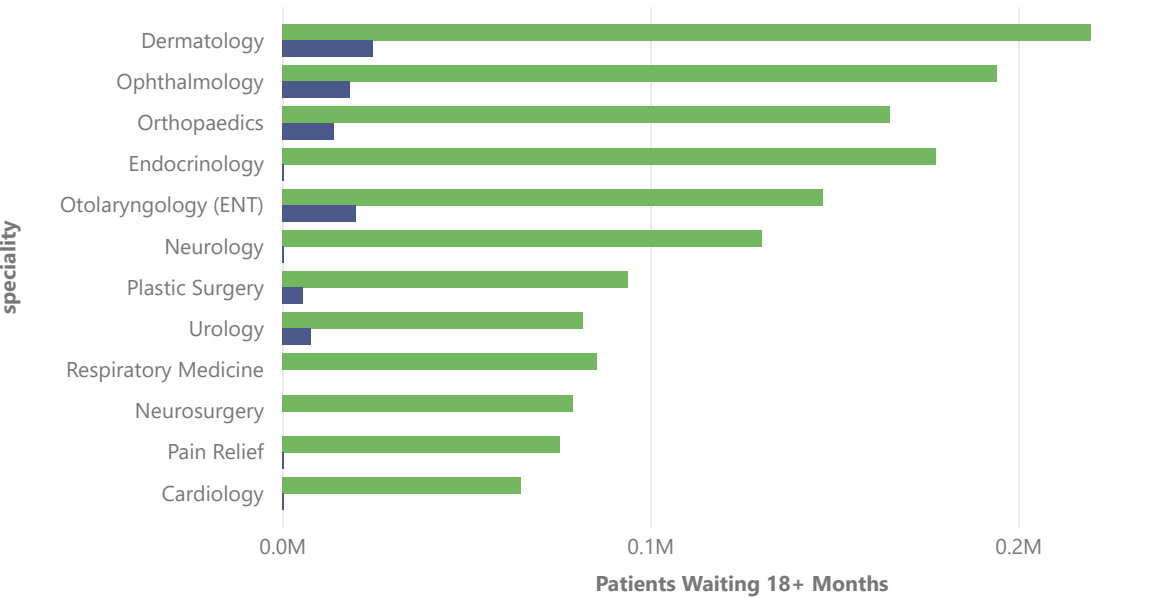


Top 10 Specialties by % Waiting Over 12 Months



18+ Month Waiters by Specialty Adults vs Children

adult_child ● Adult ● Child



Key Insights

- Orthopaedics, Dermatology and Cardiology carry the highest number of patients waiting, together accounting for the largest share of total demand across all three years.
- However, volume does not tell the full story. Oral Surgery, Neurology and Ophthalmology have the highest proportion of patients waiting over 12 months, meaning patients in these specialties face a much more severe wait relative to their list size.
- Eight of the fifteen specialties with the worst long-wait rates are children's services including Paediatric Dermatology, Paed Orthopaedics and Developmental Paediatrics. Pointing to a systemic gap in how paediatric care is being prioritised.

Is It Getting Better?

95,582

Peak 18+ Month Waiters January 2023

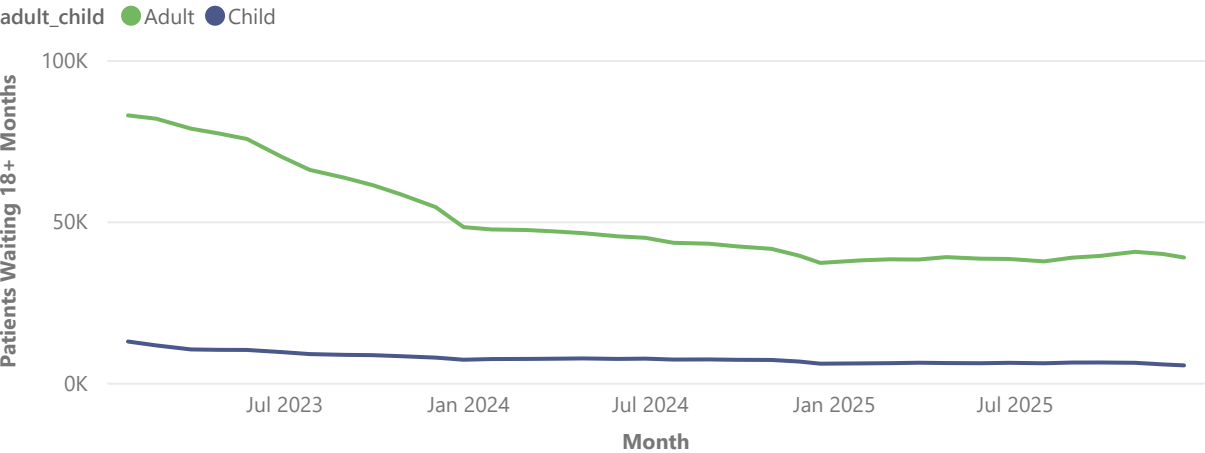
42,996

Lowest 18+ Month Waiters December 2024

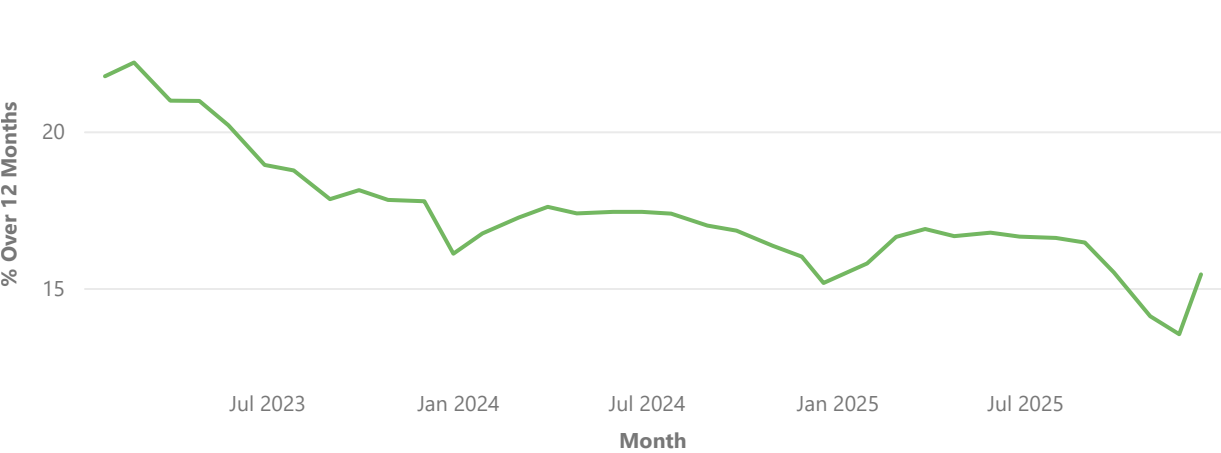
51K

Total Reduction in 18+ Month Waiters 2023–2025

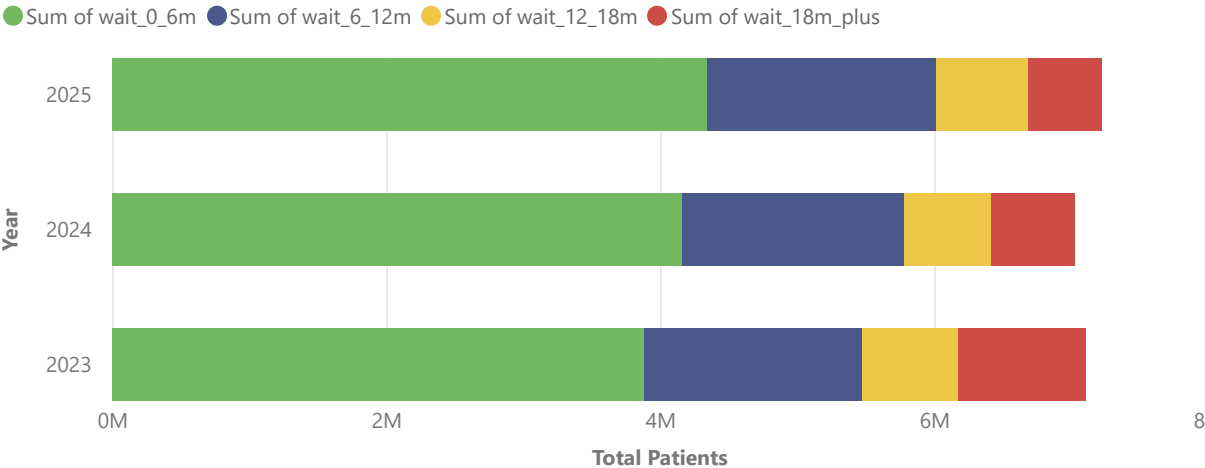
Monthly Trend Patients Waiting 18+ Months



Monthly Average % Waiting Over 12 Months



Waiting List Composition by Year Wait Time Bands



Key Insights

- The number of patients waiting more than 18 months fell sharply from 95,582 in January 2023 to around 42,000 by end of 2024 a reduction of more than 55% in two years, showing that NTPF outsourcing and insourcing initiatives had a real and measurable impact.
- However, 2025 data tells a more cautious story. The 18+ month backlog stopped falling and plateaued between 43,000 and 47,000 patients throughout the year, suggesting the easiest gains have already been made and further progress will require renewed investment.
- The composition of the waiting list is improving a growing share of patients are in the shorter 0 to 6 month band, meaning more people are being seen faster even as overall demand increases.